Activated Thinker

Run Claude Code for Free on Your Laptop

Using Ollama and Gemma 4 (No API key, no GPU, no subscription)

CodeWithYog Follow 5 min read · May 3, 2026

Photo by Craig Lovelidge on Unsplash

I tried this setup on a regular laptop. No GPU. No paid plan.

And it worked.

> *Free access for non medium members…*

Not just "it runs," but it actually builds things. let us go through the detailed process to build HTML pages, Small games, Real code you can open and test.

This guide walks through the same setup step by step. No shortcuts. No hidden steps.

Why this setup works

Most people think AI coding means cloud APIs and monthly bills. Same as I use to do before, I have ChatGPT subscription and paid for APIs to build AI systems.

That's one path. Not the only one.

Here, you combine:

- Claude Code CLI for coding workflows
- Ollama to run models locally or via cloud
- Gemma 4 as the model backend

You get a clean developer loop.

> *Prompt → code → test → repeat.*

Step 1: Install VS Code and Git

Start simple. You need a proper editor and version control.

Install Visual Studio Code.

- Download from the official site
- During setup, tick:
- Add to PATH
- Open with Code

These two save you time later.

Now install Git.

During installation:

- Select “Use Visual Studio Code as default editor”

Open VS Code → Terminal → run:

```
git --version
```

If you see a version number, you're ready.

Step 2: Install Claude Code CLI

Go to the official Claude Code site and copy the install command for Windows.

Open PowerShell and run it.

It looks like this pattern:

```
iex (something-from-website)
```

Let it install.

Fix the PATH issue

Sometimes you see a warning. It says the install location is not in PATH.

Do this:

1. Search "Environment Variables" in Windows
2. Open it

3. Edit **Path** under User variables
4. Add the folder shown in PowerShell
5. Save and restart terminal

Now test:

```
claude
```

It should launch.

When it asks to log in, press:

```
Ctrl + C
Ctrl + C
```

You skip login. You will connect it to Ollama next.

Step 3: Set up Ollama and Gemma 4

Install Ollama.

After install, verify:

```
ollama --version
```

Now search for Gemma 4 in the Ollama library.

Important choice

You will see large models like 31B.

- Local run needs high RAM and GPU
- Cloud version runs on low-end systems

Pick the cloud version.

Connect Claude Code to Gemma 4

From the Ollama page, copy the integration command.

It looks like:

```
ollama run gemma:31b-cloud
```

Or a similar cloud reference.

Now Claude CLI will use this backend for code generation.

Step 4: Try real projects

This is where it gets interesting.

Open your project folder in VS Code.
Run:

```
claude
```

Now type prompts directly.

Project 1: Basic HTML page

```
create a simple HTML page that says hello world with a black background
```

Claude writes the file.

Run:

```
start index.html
```

It opens in your browser.

Project 2: Snake game

```
create a simple single file HTML snake game using canvas API
```

You get:

- Movement logic
- Food system
- Score tracking

All in one file.

Project 3: Brick breaker game

```
create a single file HTML brickbreaker game using canvas API with score liv
```

Now you see:

- Paddle control
- Ball physics
- Brick collisions
- Game restart

This is not toy output. It runs.

What I noticed after testing

The setup feels light.

No waiting for API keys. No billing limits.
You just open terminal and start building.

Responses are fast enough for small projects.
And the loop stays inside your machine.

That changes how you experiment.

You try more ideas because the cost is zero.

Where this setup shines

- Learning frontend basics fast
- Building quick prototypes
- Testing small game logic
- Practicing prompt-based development

It is not meant for huge enterprise apps.
But for daily coding practice, it works well.

This setup removes the biggest barrier. Cost.

> *You install once, connect Ollama, and start building.*

That is the shift.
AI coding becomes part of your local workflow, not a paid service you think twice before using.

If you spend time with it, you will notice one thing.
You stop asking "should I try this?" and just try it… CodeWithYog

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You have the thought, but you need to turn it on.

Written by CodeWithYog

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